

Chapter 133-1

Liang Shi hadn't expected that Xu Qingzhu would tell her everything.

She didn't treat Zhao Xuning as an outsider at all.

Perhaps she was simply teasing her.

And Zhao Xuning played along, or rather, she was happy to see Liang Shi embarrass herself. She first let out a quick *tsk*, then drawled out her words: "So that's how it is."

Liang Shi: "....."

She wished she could find a crack in the ground to crawl into.

"Miss Liang, do you need me to prescribe some medicine to help you out?" Zhao Xuning asked with a smile.

Liang Shi: "....."

Normally, Zhao Xuning's face was always sour, never showing anyone a smile.

To observe whether she was in a good mood, you had to look at the subtle details like her tone and gaze—it was particularly difficult.

But now she kept smiling; the corners of her mouth hadn't dropped since entering the private room.

It wasn't because Liang Shi had woken up—she was simply happy teasing Liang Shi.

One's happiness is always built upon another's misery.

Liang Shi glared at her, looked at the wine glasses in front of them, and said through gritted teeth: "How about a competition?"

Zhao Xuning provoked: "Oh? Compete at what?"

Liang Shi: "...Drinking."

"I thought you wanted to compete with me at something else." Zhao Xuning shrugged: "I'm telling you, you can't bring those anything-goes¹ antics to me, or you'd be as good as dead."

Liang Shi: "...Today, don't even think about walking out of this room upright."

Zhao Xuning raised her eyebrow: "So fierce."

Liang Shi: "I have to show you whether I can... do it or not."

The last three words were said through gritted teeth, sounding quite indignant.

Zhao Xuning laughed, "Hey, I wasn't the one who said you couldn't do it—your wife said it. Besides, this is something the two of you can prove to each other. What the hell does it have to do with me?"

Those narrow, fox-like eyes carried a half-smiling expression.

Without her glasses, Zhao Xuning was the alluring type. Normally, she carried herself with an aloof air and a sour expression, making anyone who saw her feel she was unapproachable.

But now she actually showed a few traces of charm.

She clearly hadn't drunk much yet, but her speech was much coarser than usual.

She had probably loosened up.

Liang Shi patted her once, "Drinking or not?"

Zhao Xuning: "...What's the wager?"

Liang Shi: "If you lose, you call Shen Hui and tell her everything in your heart."

Zhao Xuning: "...Can you be any more annoying?"

Xu Qingzhu, sitting to the side, glanced sideways at Liang Shi. The lights in the private room were bright, illuminating her with a gentle and beautiful glow.

Zhao Xuning raised her wine glass and drained it in one gulp, her gaze wandering as she looked at the glass, "Change the wager. Don't bring other people into this."

"She's not just 'other people.'" Liang Shi said: "She's the one you love."

Zhao Xuning: "...Liang Shi."

Zhao Xuning called her name very seriously: "You're being really naggy right now."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together: "That's because you haven't experienced..."

She paused, and her originally gentle voice suddenly became choked with emotion, "That feeling of never being able to see someone again. In that moment, you'd be willing to trade so many things, including your life, but there's nothing you can do. You can't do anything, you can't see that person—it's more terrifying than being separated by death²..."

Liang Shi's eyes turned red as she spoke.

She had just experienced a parting—a parting from that world.

She also truly regarded Zhao Xuning as a friend and didn't want her to keep being so stubborn.

Liang Shi was now so emotional that when she said these words, tears welled up in her eyes.

According to the physical constitution of this world, Alphas were far less emotional than Omegas, naturally lacking a kind of empathy.

But Liang Shi had grown up in another world. Although her body was that of an Alpha, psychologically she had very strong empathy.

Especially after what she had just experienced.

As she spoke, Xu Qingzhu's hand fell on the back of her hand, gently patting it.

Though the back of her hand was touched by coolness, Liang Shi felt warmth.

Zhao Xuning lowered her eyes and listened to her quietly.

Footnotes:

¹ "葷素不忌" (hūn sù bù jì) - literally means "eating both meat and vegetables without restriction," but is commonly used as an idiom meaning someone who is indiscriminate, willing to do anything, or has no limits in what they'll say or do (often with suggestive undertones).

² "天人永隔" (tiān rén yǒng gé) - a Chinese idiom meaning "separated forever between heaven and earth," referring to the permanent separation of death where the living and the dead can never meet again.